

Digilians

SKILLS MODULE

Presentation Skills

PRESENTATION SKILLS

Participant's Manual



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Module 1: Introduction to Presentations

Presentation Skills for Freelancers

Why it matters:

- Freelancers often need to pitch ideas, explain concepts, and communicate value clearly—to clients, collaborators, or audiences.
- Strong presentation skills can help you stand out, win work, and build lasting relationships.
- Presentations offer opportunities for developing skills and knowledge together.
- This process can help your audience gain more background about what you want to say.
- If the presentation is effective, the audience should have learned something new and increased their interest in it (WIIFM).

Why do people fear presentations?

1. Fear of making embarrassing mistakes
2. Fear of risking reputation
3. Fear of forgetting
4. Fear of being boring
5. Fear of looking nervous

Characteristics of Effective Presenters



Confident



Enthusiastic



Credible



Organized & well structured



Can use storytelling skills



Has ability to connect with audience

Effective Presenters

- The most effective presenters and communicators have a strong sense of their identities and a level of self-awareness acquired through reflecting on their beliefs, attitudes, and behavioral patterns.

Your Presentation

1. Purpose:

- What is the specific purpose? (i.e., what is your main message?)
- What do you want the audience to do as a result of your presentation?

2. Audience background:

- Who will be in the audience?
- What is their level of knowledge, expertise, education, etc..?
- What do the audience members have in common? How do they differ from each other?

3. Structure:

- The content of any presentation needs to have a clear structure.
- This will allow the audience to understand your key message and leave the presentation feeling that it has been a worthwhile experience.

4. Style

The way you deliver the presentation or your unique style while presenting.

The styles:

- Visual Style
- Coach Style
- Storytelling Style

Visual Style

What it is:

- If you're an effective improviser, slides simply exist to complement your message.
- With this speaking style, you will need to get your audience engaged.

When to use it:

- This style is helpful when a freelancer is speaking to a large audience with diverse interests.

Coach Style

What it is:

- Energetic speakers go towards this style of presenting. It allows them to connect and engage with their audience.

When to use it:

- Use this presentation style when you're speaking at a conference or presenting to an audience who needs to be persuaded and influenced by your freelance services.

Storytelling Style

What it is:

- In this style, the freelancer relies on anecdotes and examples to connect with the audience.
- Stories bring your learning points to life.

When to use it:

- This style is great for conference speaking, networking events, and sales presentations where you have adequate time to tell your stories to relate to the main objective of your presentation.

Module 2: Structure of Presentations

Presentation Structure

1. Opening

Purpose: To grab the audience's attention, establish a connection (rapport), and introduce the topic and main purpose of the presentation.

A. Introduction and Welcome

- Start your presentation with a welcome and a quick introduction of yourself by giving background information on who you are.
- Also, thank your audience for their time and acknowledge their efforts and participation in the presentation.

B. Grabbing Attention

- Present an interesting question or problem.
- Show an interesting statistic, chart or image.
- Quote an influential or interesting person.
- Share a story that leads to the main topic of your presentation.
- A video that relates to the topic of the presentation

C. Agenda

- Present an outline of the main ideas you will cover in the presentation
- This will keep your audience focused on the presentation topics.

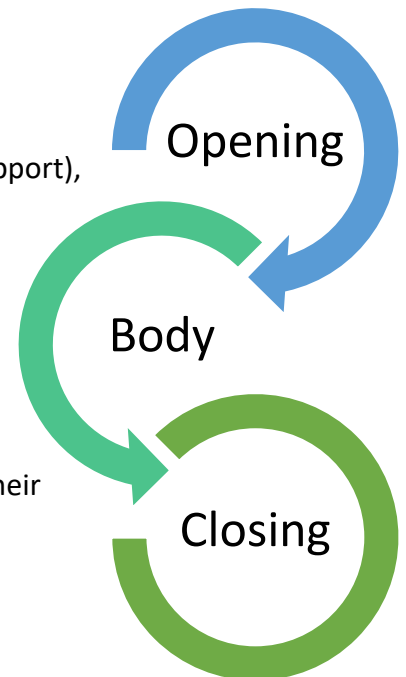
2. Body

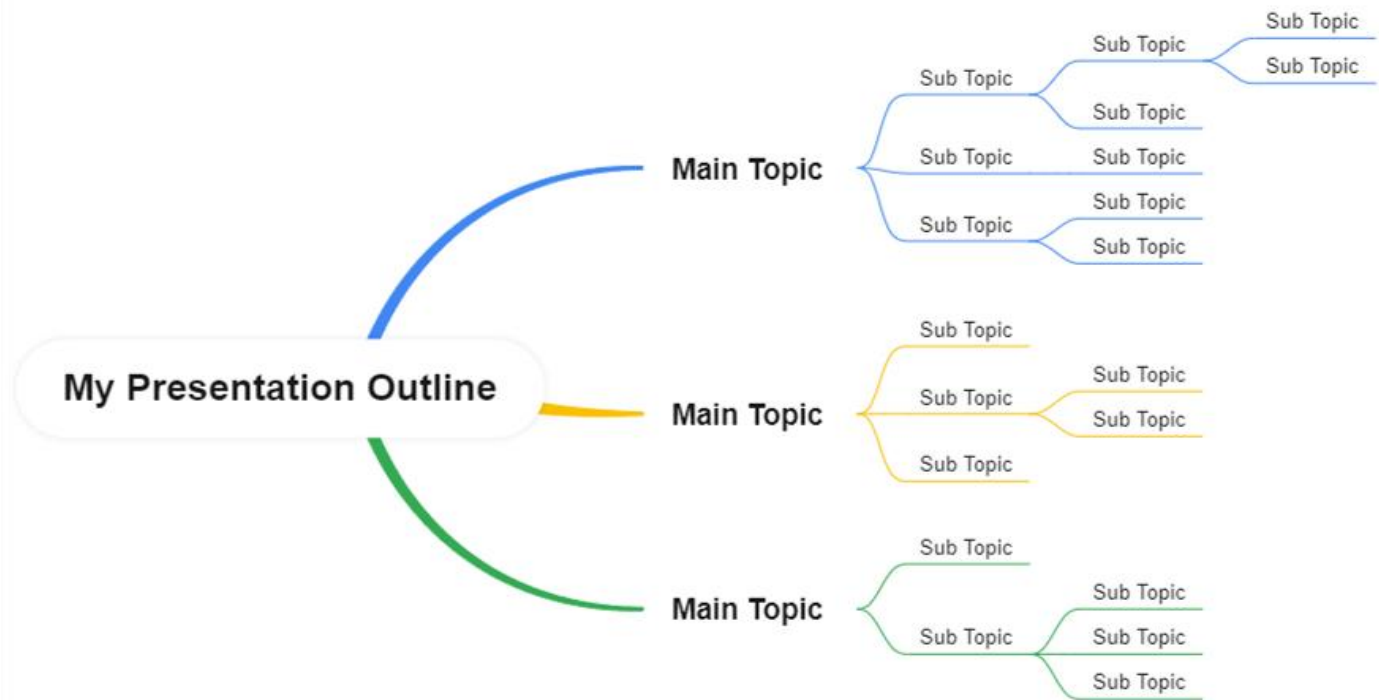
Purpose: To deliver the core content of the presentation, providing main points and supporting them with evidence, examples, or stories.

Structure: Present your main ideas in a logical order in the form of an outline.

Key Elements:

- Key Points: Identify the most crucial information you want to convey.
- Supporting Evidence: Use facts, data, or illustrations to back up your points.
- Engagement: Keep the audience interested by balancing information with interesting content like images or stories.





Solution Outline

- Customer needs
- Features
- Benefits
- USP's
- Timeline/Implementation plan
- Financial offer (if applicable)

3. Closing

Techniques:

- Provide a summary of ideas
- End with a key message
- Allow questions
- Call to action

Visual Aids

Visual aids are able to:

- clarify data that may be difficult for the audience to grasp from a verbal presentation alone.
- highlight your main ideas.
- help your audience remember your main ideas.
- help you give much information in a very short space of time.
- shorten meetings.
- Reinforce and clarify key points.
- Engage audience's eyes and ears.
- Improve understanding and retention.
- Create consistency and balance.
- Inspire confidence in message legitimacy.

Common Types of Visual Aids

- Computer Aided
- Slides
- Flip Charts
- Handouts
- Videos
- Films
- White Board

Visual Aids Tools

Online presentation software allows users to connect with their audience engagingly. These tools also incorporate images, create movement, and work across many platforms.



Six Tips for Visual Aids

1. Keep it short and simple
2. Make it readable
3. Use appropriate size and font
4. Check colors
5. Proofread
6. Use animation carefully

Infographics



Module 3: Delivering Presentations

Nonverbal Communication

Body Language

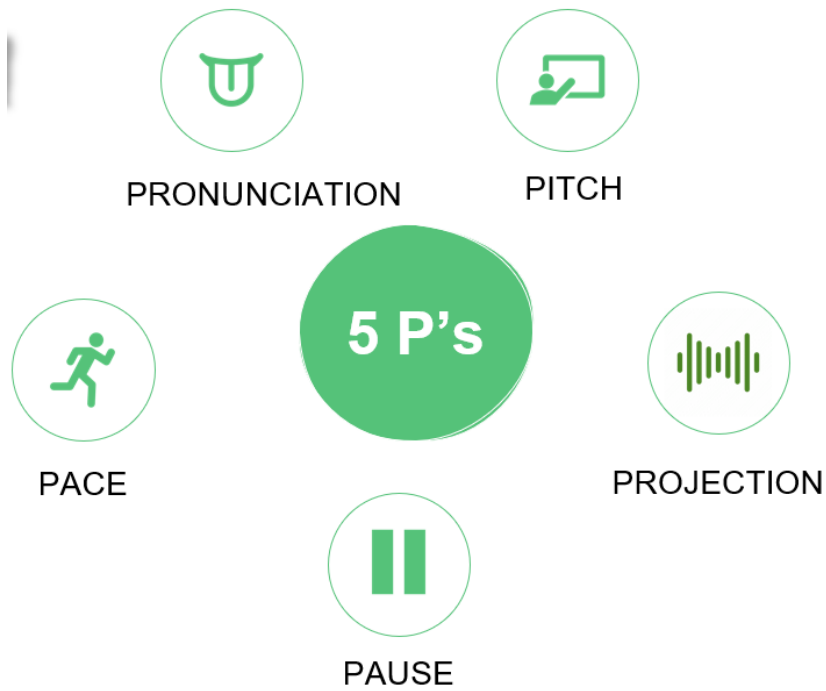
- We get 65-75% of our sense of what other people are saying from their body language.
- Make your face look friendly.
- Closing your arms sends a negative message to others.
- Learn to pick up cues from people that you are making them uncomfortable.

Eye Contact

Posture

Hand
Movement

Tone of voice



Delivering Virtual Presentations

1. Proper Webcam, Lighting & Internet Connection

- First, check your webcam and lighting. Before you present, turn on your webcam and make sure you're visible.
- Use this time to also check your microphone and audio source.
- Check the background.
- Know the platform used.

2. Talk to the Camera

- Keep eye contact with the camera.
- If you're simply reading from a screen, it makes it seem like you're not confident in the content you're presenting.

3. Show Enthusiasm

- Displaying your interest and care for the topic or information you are presenting will engage and capture the audience's attention.
- People enjoy listening to people who are genuinely excited about sharing their knowledge with others.

4. Use Your Voice Effectively

- Use a strong & confident speaking voice
- Vary your intonation
- Practice, practice, practice

5. Be Yourself

- The most important tip of them all is to be yourself.
- When you're yourself, you'll be more genuine and credible.

Stage Fright

Tips for Reducing Stage Fright:

- Ask yourself, “What’s the worst thing that could happen?”
- Believe in your message.
- Think positive and use relaxation techniques.
- Practice! Practice! Practice!

NOTES

PRESENTATION SKILLS
